

(you may have seen Richard Gere hang upside down in these in the movie *American Gigolo*) and wanted to know if I was interested in looking at them. I checked things out and decided the boots were dynamite, but he wasn't, so I got involved on my own.

I began selling the boots to sporting-goods and department stores. I noticed these retail outlets all had one thing in common—crummy exercise equipment. My brain bells went berserk —“Opportunity, opportunity, opportunity.” Funny how things happen. This was my first experience selling exercise equipment, which eventually led me